A neutral ruler for cell data.

An open reference for what "normal" cells look like in every lab, held by a nonprofit.

01 THE MOMENT

Biology is pooling cell data to train AI.
Nobody calibrates it across the labs that make it.

$1.8B
Biohub's virtual-cell initiative with DeepMind, Meta, DOE, NIH [1]

120M
open single-cell data points from Tahoe, Arc and Biohub [2]

$30–50M
a typical FRO: 5 years, 15–30 people [3]

Building models: Biohub, Arc, Xaira, Noetik, Rivercell. **Calibrating across labs:** nobody yet.
The gap: a model names the lab from control wells alone, 99.9% vs 9.1% chance (public JUMP data).

02 WHY AN FRO

Neutral	The holder of a reference must not profit from the answer.
Unbuilt	Consortia publish but don't refresh; platforms erase the lab signal.
Proven	EvE Bio, a Convergent FRO, already runs a public drug–target dataset [4].
Fundable	ARIA and Convergent launched two UK FROs in April 2026; NSF is piloting up to $1B for labs like this [6][7].

03 TWO LAYERS

NONPROFIT FRO
The open reference
- map of every lab's controls
- the standard for drift
- open benchmark

→ map
← licence

MEMBER SPIN-OUT
Membership
- labs that share join free
- screening teams pay per line
- AI teams pay by API

Open: map, standard, code.
Paid: private-batch checks, API.
Only control wells are shared.
Each lab keeps its data and a share.

04 FIVE YEARS PROPOSED

Phase 0 · $1.77M
18 months: U2OS map, brightfield test
fails if brightfield misses drift

Years 1–2
30 labs, 3 lines, open benchmark
fails if drift misses failures

Year 3
100 labs, 10 lines, in a consortium's terms
fails if no consortium adopts it

Years 4–5
Spin-out carries the map; standard handed off
fails if membership falls short

05 TEAM

Kat Titterton, scientific lead. Cell Painting papers with the Broad (2026); Insitro, Axiom Bio, MIT, AbbVie.

Hiring: executive director, data, partnerships.

06 WHERE IT LANDS

- Convergent UK residency, due 19 Feb 2027 [5]
- NSF Tech Labs pilot [6]
- Virtual-cell builders as partners and API members

[1] pharmaphorum, Oct 2026 · [2] GEN, Jan 2026 · [3] *Issues*, 2025 · [4] convergentresearch.org · [5] Essential Tech · [6] FAS · [7] PR Newswire